in the district.

The reference, which contains the names of 3522 persons with criminal records, runs into 266 bound pages. The names of the persons are listed in alphabetical order under the various sections of the Indian Penal Code.

Mrs Kiran Bedi, Deputy Commissioner of Police for the district, said that the ready reference would help policemen to ascertain immediately if the suspect had any previous record.

The ready reference will supplement the one prepared and circulated by the central crime record office at R. K. Puram [a locality in South Delhi]. It will be updated from time to time.

(*The Times of India*, 12 July 1981)

Kiran was posted as the DCP of the West District by default (she was sent there to fill up a leave vacancy). Due to the indisputable success she achieved in this posting within a short period, she could not be pulled back because of popular demand. Within weeks, the crime pattern of the district had started to show a dramatic fall. Illicit liquor sales had dried up. Incidents of molestation of women declined. People started to volunteer to maintain vigil at night for checking crimes both in urban areas as well as in the 116 villages falling under her jurisdiction. Training for watchmen (appointed by the various residents' welfare associations) had been initiated.

The welfare of the staff was her priority; criminal reform was her strategy. She sought to check recidivism among past offenders.

Night barriers were erected to seal the West District in case serious crimes were reported from the neighbouring districts. This feature made her district stand apart from the others. She won the hearts of the rank and file by ensuring that all of them were served hot tea while on night patrolling duty during the cold winter months. She would personally come out on night patrols, five times a week, not only checking the alertness of all those involved but also looking after their welfare. Rewards for good performance were instant. She stood by her staff through thick and thin, as also by people with a firm sense of justice. She is known to have questioned an arrest from her district, by the neighbouring district police chief, because she believed it to be on a false pretext. Such questioning brought her in direct confrontation with her seniormost boss. But she did not relent. Ensuring fairness as well as delivering justice, particularly for the vulnerable sections, was both her weakness and strength, as one sees all along in her career. All these innovations in the concepts of welfare policing made headlines, because they were novel and unique.

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In 1988 she took over charge as deputy director of the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB). During this tenure she again hit the headlines. In a lightning swoop she made from Delhi into the verdant hills of Chakrata *tehsil* (then in the interiors of north-western Uttar Pradesh and now in the state of Uttarakhand), she physically supervised the destruction of almost 12 hectares under illegal poppy and cannabis cultivation. This task she undertook in spite of the fact that it was the constituency represented by a powerful sitting Member of Parliament, Brahm Dutt, of the then ruling Congress Government.

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There appears a discernible transparency in her work, especially in organizations that had